



Many unborn babies have been filmed yawning on 4-D scans, which give a very up-close view of fetal behavior.

TALKING TO YOUR BABY

Your developing baby's ears are structurally complete, and studies show that he can hear clearly now. Your breathing and heartbeat and the gurgles of your digestive system provide a constant background rhythm, but he's also aware of other sounds.

In one study, ultrasounds of fetuses showed that they had a “blink-startle” response to loud noises from around 24 weeks. Talking to your baby will help you to bond: research indicates that newborns recognize—and turn toward—the sound of their mother's voice in preference to other female voices. To begin with he'll hear deeper voices more clearly, but later he'll register higher-pitched sounds. He will, of course, become more familiar with your voice, partly because this is what he will hear most often and because your body is a good conductor of sound vibration.

LEFT-HANDED BABIES

Women aged over 40 are more than twice as likely to have left-handed babies. This is according to a Canadian study and may be related to the fact that older women are more likely to experience complications in pregnancy and have more arduous deliveries. Several studies show a correlation between left-handedness and birth stress.